

TANG ZICHEN

☎ +86 13792518288 ✉ ztangap@connect.ust.hk 🌐 github.com/trl730109 🌐 trl730109.github.io 🎓 [Google Scholar](#)

Education

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Sep 2025 – Present

PhD Student, Supervisor: Prof. Bo LI

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou) Sep 2023 – Jul 2025

MPhil in Data Science and Analytics, Supervisors: Prof. Xiaowen CHU, Prof. Sihong XIE

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Sep 2019 – Jun 2023

BEng in Computer Science and Mathematics (Double Major)

Publications

* Equal contribution. † Corresponding author.

Distributed / Federated ML Systems

- Z. Tang*, J. Huang*, **Z. Tang***, X. Kang, Y. Wang, P. Dong, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. Capturing and Mitigating Gradient Aggregation Errors for Fault-Tolerant Distributed Training. (ICML'26).
- Z. Tang*, **Z. Tang***, J. Huang, X. Pan, R. Yan, Y. Wang, A. Zhou, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. DreamDDP: Accelerating Data Parallel Distributed LLM Training with Layer-wise Scheduled Partial Synchronization. (MLSys'26).
- **Z. Tang**, J. Huang, R. Yan, Y. Wang, Z. Tang, S. Shi, A. Zhou, X. Chu. Bandwidth-Aware and Overlap-Weighted Compression for Communication-Efficient Federated Learning. (ICPP'24).

Trustworthy & Data-centric LLM (Safety, Bias, Knowledge Injection)

- **Z. Tang***, Z. Tang*, G. Pan, B. Liu, X. He, K. Lai, X. Chu, B. Li. Ghost in the Cloud: Your Geo-Distributed Large Language Models Training is Easily Manipulated. (ICLR'26).
- **Z. Tang**, Z. Tang, Y. Hou, H. Xing, X. Qi, X. Chu, B. Li. Anchoring the Bridge Across Hops: Unlocking Latent Multi-Hop Reasoning under Knowledge Injection. (CL4FMAgents @ NeurIPS'26).
- **Z. Tang**, Z. Tang, Y. Hou, P. Dong, X. Liu, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li. Enhancing Knowledge Injection with Surrounding Backgrounds in Continual Training LLMs. (ICML'26 Workshop).
- **Z. Tang***, Z. Tang*†, Q. Wang, G. Pan, Y. Yang, W. He, S. Shi, X. Chu, B. Li†. BiasTrojan: LLM Judges Are Easily Distorted by Few Hundreds of Contrastive Biased Training Data. (NeurIPS'26).
- **Z. Tang***, Z. Zhang*, Q. Wang, Z. Tang†, X. Chu, B. Li†. Is Your LLM-as-a-Recommender Agent Trustable? LLMs' Recommendation is Easily Hacked by Biases (Preferences). (NeurIPS'26 Evaluations and Datasets Track).

Research Interest

Federated/Distributed ML Systems

Data-centric LLM

LLM Agent

Projects

Agent Inference Task Decomposition and Cost Modeling Nov 2025 – Present

- Decomposing multi-round Agent tasks into a DAG of LLM-inference and tool-call sub-nodes to enable fine-grained global scheduling.
- Building a precise per-node inference cost model for Qwen3-8B (prefill / decode / memory / communication) coupled with a DeBERTa-v3 output-length predictor.

Teaching

COMP 3511 – Operating Systems, Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026; Fall 2027

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Service

ICML 2026, Gold Reviewer

2026

Recognized for high-quality reviewing.

Skills

Professional Skills: Python, PyTorch, PyTorch Distributed, Horovod, DeepSpeed, FSDP, TRL, SGLang, Verl

Language Proficiency: English (TOEFL 105), Chinese (Native), Cantonese (Elementary)

Examination Performance: GRE 324 (Verbal 154, Quant 170, Writing 3.5)